	Consolidated 2003 $000	Consolidated 2002 $000
6 Dividends (continued)		
Dividend franking account		
30% franking credits available to shareholders of ASXL for subsequent financial years	19,363	14,510

The above available amounts are based on the balance of the dividend franking account at year-end adjusted for:

(a) franking credits that will arise from the payment of the current income tax payable; and
(b) franking debits that will arise from the payment of dividends recognised as a liability at the year-end.

The ability to utilise the franking credits is dependent upon there being sufficient available profits to declare dividends.

Change in measurement of dividend franking amount
In accordance with the New Business Tax System (Imputation) Act 2002, the measurement basis of the dividend franking account changed on 1 July 2002 from an after-tax profits basis to an income taxes paid basis.

The amount of franking credits available to shareholders disclosed as at 30 June 2003 has been measured under the new legislation and represents income tax paid amounts available to frank distributions.

The change in the basis of measurement does not change the underlying value of franking credits or tax offsets available to shareholders from the dividend franking account.

Comparative information has been restated for this change in measurement.

	Consolidated 2003	Consolidated 2002
7 Earnings per share		
Basic earnings per share (cents)	56.6	58.3
Diluted earnings per share (cents)	56.2	57.7

	2003 $000	2002 $000
The following reflects the income and share data used in the calculation of basic and diluted earnings per share:		
Earnings used in calculating basic and diluted earnings per share	57,753	59,132

	Number of shares	Number of shares
Weighted average number of ordinary shares used in calculating basic earnings per share	101,971,038	101,476,027
Effect of dilutive securities: Contingently issuable shares	729,424	1,040,445
Weighted average number of ordinary shares used in calculating diluted earnings per share	102,700,462	102,516,472
Weighted average number of converted, lapsed or cancelled potential ordinary shares included in the calculation of diluted earnings per share	3,140	11,749